

HEALTH & FITNESS · MOBILE APP

Pulse — turning daily movement into a habit people keep

A fitness companion that makes progress feel motivating at a glance — activity rings, forgiving streaks and one-tap workouts that lower the friction of simply showing up.

ROLE

UX / UI Designer

TIMELINE

6 weeks

PLATFORM

iOS & Android

TOOLS

Figma · Maze · Lookback

01

The Problem

Fitness apps are downloaded with good intentions and abandoned within weeks. The barrier isn't features — it's **motivation**. Data-heavy dashboards feel like homework, and a single missed day triggers guilt that spirals into quitting.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

How might we keep people motivated to move every day by making progress feel rewarding — and effortless to track?

73%

of fitness-app users quit within 30 days

#1

churn reason: lost motivation

2×

retention when progress is visible daily

02

Goals & Success Metrics



Glanceable progress

Understand today's activity in under 3 seconds.



Forgiving motivation

Celebrate streaks without punishing missed days.



Zero-friction start

Begin a workout in one tap from the home screen.

Target metrics: ring comprehension > 90% · time-to-start workout < 10s · SUS > 80 · motivation rating ↑.

03

User Research

11 user interviews

Survey — 60 respondents

Competitive audit — Apple Fitness, Strava, Nike

Diary study (1 week)

Key findings

1 Visible streaks & rings pull people back

Seeing a nearly-closed ring is the single strongest motivator to move.

2 Guilt causes churn

"Failed" days and red warnings make users delete the app. Encouraging, forgiving language keeps them.

3 Starting is the hard part

Any friction before a workout (setup, choices) kills the intent to exercise.

4 Achievement > competition

Personal streaks motivate more broadly than leaderboards.

**Rahul Menon**

30 · Product Manager · time-poor

"I have 20 minutes. Just tell me what to do and let me feel like I did something."

GOALS

- Quick daily wins that fit a busy day
- See streaks build up over time

FRUSTRATIONS

- Too many taps before a workout
- Overwhelming stats with no meaning

**Sana Kapoor**

26 · Teacher · returning to fitness

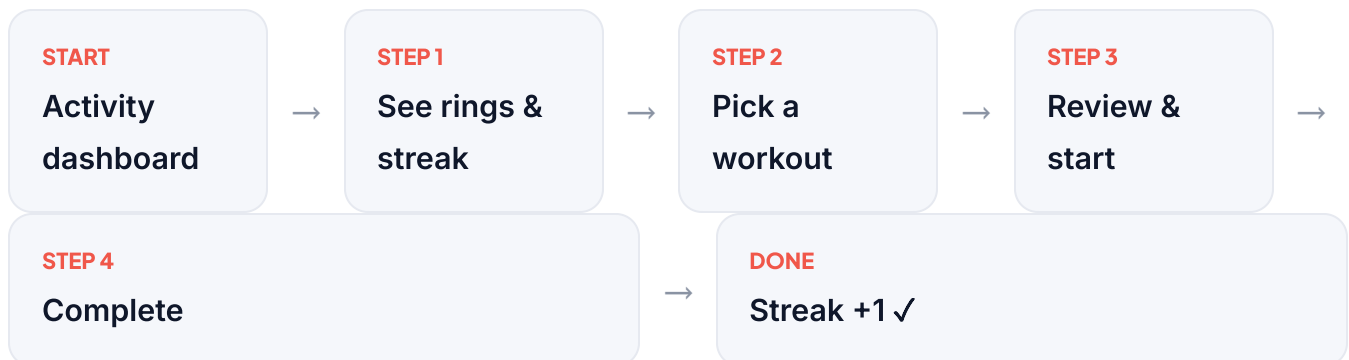
"I've started and stopped so many times — I need encouragement, not another app making me feel bad."

GOALS

- Build a sustainable, gentle routine
- Feel supported when she misses a day

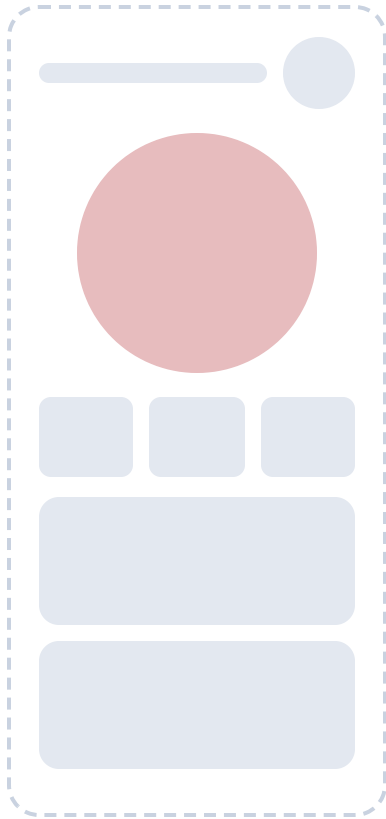
FRUSTRATIONS

- Guilt-inducing "you failed" messaging
- Intimidating, athlete-focused apps

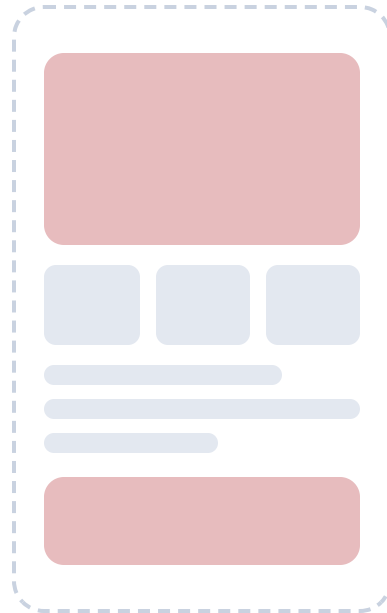


06 Wireframes

Low-fi explored putting glanceable progress first and reducing the workout-detail page to a single decision: start.



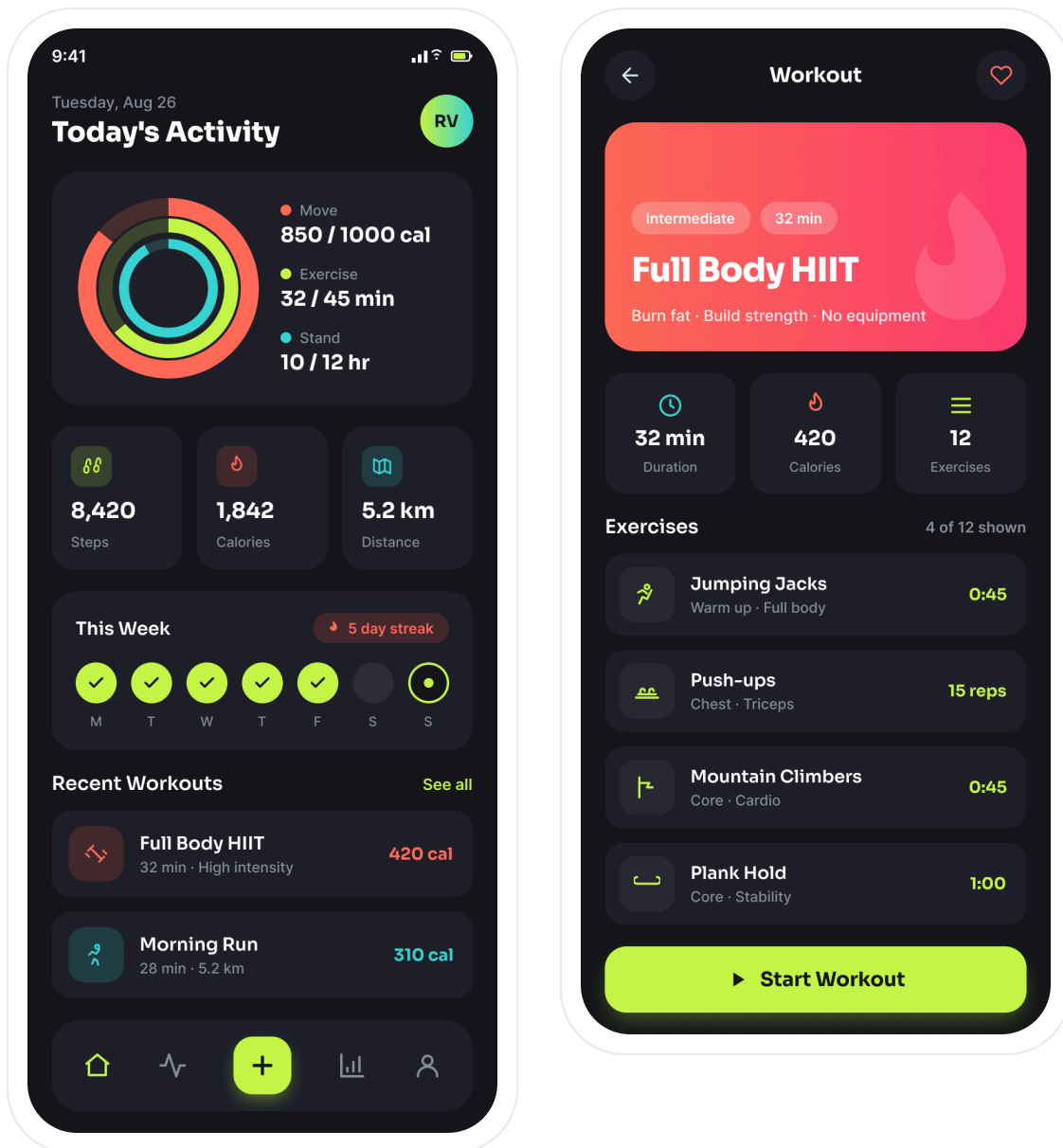
Dashboard — rings + stats + workouts



Workout — details + sticky Start

Hi-Fi Design & Prototype

Concentric activity rings make progress instantly readable; a forgiving streak celebrates consistency; and the workout page collapses to one confident “Start” action.



Activity dashboard & workout detail — high-fidelity screens

Key design decisions



Concentric rings

Move / Exercise / Stand in one glanceable visual — progress you feel, not read.



Forgiving streak

Encouraging copy and a “rest day” state instead of failure warnings.



One-tap start

A prominent Start button removes friction between intent and action.

Usability Testing

6 participants, moderated remote sessions via Lookback.

Tasks: (1) "How are you doing on today's activity?" (2) "Start the Full Body HIIT workout."

METRIC	TARGET	RESULT
Ring comprehension	> 90%	94%
Time to start a workout	< 10s	7s
System Usability Scale	> 80	88
Motivation rating (1–5)	↑	4.5

What testing changed

ITERATION 1

Two users weren't sure which ring meant what. → Added a **colour-coded legend with live values** beside the rings.

ITERATION 2

The Start action competed with the exercise list. → Made **"Start Workout"** a **sticky, high-contrast button** anchored to the bottom.

09

Results & Impact

94%

understood
progress rings
instantly

7s

to start a workout
(target <10s)

88

SUS score

4.5/5

reported
motivation

10

Reflection & Next Steps

The insight that reframed the project: **emotion, not data, drives retention.**
Designing forgiving, celebratory moments mattered more than adding metrics.
Rings worked because they turn progress into a feeling.

Next: adaptive workout suggestions, gentle re-engagement after a break, and optional friend "cheers" for accountability without competition.

UX Research

Behavioural Design

Data Visualization

Interaction Design

Usability Testing